

## SEED SHRIMPS

Seed shrimps belong to the class Ostracoda. The entire body of a seed shrimp is enclosed within a two-valve hinged carapace, with just the limbs poking through. If threatened, the animal can shut itself inside. These small crustaceans crawl through vegetation in marine and freshwater habitats; some use their antennae to swim.

### GIANT SWIMMING SEED SHRIMP

*Gigantocypris* sp.  
F: Cypridinidae

Most seed shrimps are tiny crustaceans with two-valved carapaces; this is a large, deep-sea species with big eyes for hunting bioluminescent prey.

2–3 cm  
¾–1¼ in



### CRAWLING SEED SHRIMP

*Cypris* sp.  
F: Cypridinidae

This widespread freshwater crustacean belongs to a group of small, hard-shelled seed shrimps that crawl through detritus.

0.5–2 mm  
¼–⅛ in



## CRABS AND RELATIVES

The Malacostraca class is the most diverse crustacean group. The basic features are head, thorax, and an abdomen with multiple limbs. Two large orders within this class include the decapods, which have a carapace that curves round the fused head-thorax to contain a gill cavity, and the isopods (woodlice and relatives), which lack a carapace and are the largest group of land-living crustaceans.



1.5–2.2 cm  
½–⅞ in

### COMMON SANDHOPPER

*Orchestia gammarellus*  
F: Talitridae

One of many amphipods (sideways-flattened crustaceans), this is a European intertidal sandhopper – so called because it can jump by flipping its abdomen.

1–2 cm  
⅜–¾ in



### COMMON FRESHWATER SHRIMP

*Gammarus pulex*  
F: Gammaridae

This N. European amphipod, abundant in freshwater streams, belongs to a family of detritus-eating freshwater shrimps. Related species inhabit brackish waters.

### SPINY SKELETON SHRIMP

*Caprella acanthifera*  
F: Caprellidae

Like other skeleton shrimps, this is a slender, slow-moving, predatory amphipod with few legs. It clings to seaweeds in European rockpools.

13 mm  
½ in

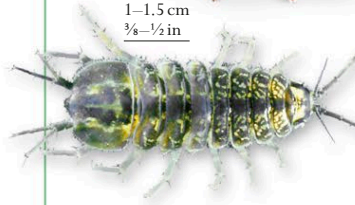


### COMMON WATER SLATER

*Asellus aquaticus*  
F: Asellidae

A common European member of a family of freshwater woodlice relatives, this species crawls among detritus in stagnant water.

1–1.5 cm  
⅜–½ in



2–3 cm  
¾–1¼ in



### COMMON SEA SLATER

*Ligia oceanica*  
F: Ligiidae

A large coastal woodlouse, this European species lives in rock crevices above the intertidal zone. It feeds on detritus.



### BLACK-HEADED WOODLOUSE

*Porcellio spinicornis*  
F: Porcellionidae

Often living alongside humans, especially in lime-rich habitats, this distinctly marked woodlouse is native to Europe but has invaded N. America.

10–12 cm  
4–4¾ in



1–1.8 cm  
⅜–¾ in

### COMMON PILL WOODLOUSE

*Armadillidium vulgare*  
F: Armadillidiidae

Pill woodlice are characterized by their ability to roll into a ball when disturbed. This species is widespread across Eurasia and introduced elsewhere.



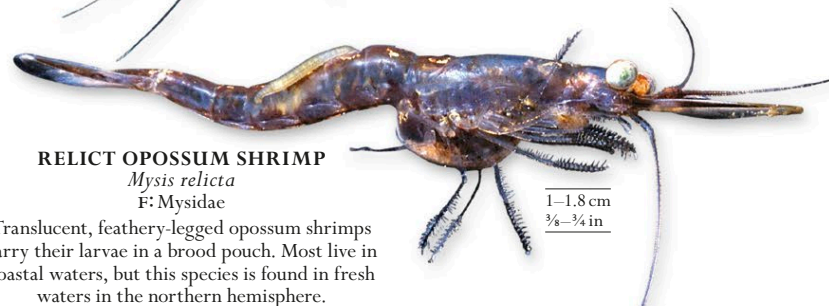
4–6 cm  
1½–2¼ in

### RELICT OPOSSUM SHRIMP

*Mysis relicta*  
F: Mysidae

Translucent, feathery-legged opossum shrimps carry their larvae in a brood pouch. Most live in coastal waters, but this species is found in fresh waters in the northern hemisphere.

1–1.8 cm  
⅜–¾ in



### ANTARCTIC KRILL

*Euphausia superba*  
F: Euphausiidae

Swarms of these plankton-feeding crustaceans are critical components of the Southern Ocean food chains that support whales, seals, and seabirds.

abdomen

### GIANT DEESEA ISOPOD

*Bathynomus giganteus*  
F: Cirolanidae

A giant marine relative of woodlice, this species crawls along ocean floors, scavenging on dead animals and occasionally taking live prey.

19–36 cm  
7½–14 in



tail fin used for swimming

segmented exoskeleton